AI Connector Channel Performance: Executive Summary

Mailchimp vs QuickBooks & ChatGPT vs Claude | April 11, 2026

Scale & Growth Velocity

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
Total connections	4,792	4,830	2,899	2,693
Days since launch	~130	13	130	10
Daily adds (current)	~60 (steady)	280–440	~15 (declining)	~269

Mailchimp is at roughly **half of QBO's scale** on both channels. Claude is the growth story on both platforms — QBO's Claude overtook ChatGPT in 13 days; Mailchimp's Claude will overtake ChatGPT within days at current rates. The critical difference: QBO's ChatGPT holds steady at ~60/day while **Mailchimp's ChatGPT has decayed 67%** from its Jan peak of 45/day to just 15/day. Claude's daily velocity is comparable across platforms (~269 MC vs 280–440 QBO).

User Composition: Existing Accounts, Not New Customers

Over **90% of both ChatGPT and Claude connections on Mailchimp are existing accounts**. Of the connected user base, Claude skews more toward paid plans (**63.4% paid**) than ChatGPT (**52.6% paid**) — both far above any other Mailchimp integration channel (Shopify: 10%, Canva: 18%). These are power users adding AI tools to active accounts, not new customers discovering Mailchimp.

Engagement: Mailchimp's Advantage Over QBO — Claude Leads ChatGPT

	QBO ChatGPT	QBO Claude	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude
AI feature engagement (eligible)	53%	49%	**63%**	**82%**
Premium / Advanced tier	73%	68%	**88%**	**96%**

Mailchimp outperforms QBO on engagement across every tier. Within Mailchimp, **Claude users are dramatically more active than ChatGPT**: 82% weekly active vs 63%, with Premium Claude at a near-perfect 96%. Part of this reflects Claude's recency (10 days vs 130), but ChatGPT's 63% at maturity still exceeds QBO's best number (53%). Even ChatGPT's free-tier users show 23% WAU, while Claude's free tier hits 61%.

Product Attachment: Automations Strong, Secondary Products Lag

MC Product	MC ChatGPT	MC Claude	MC Platform Avg	AI Multiplier	QBO Equivalent
Automations	**40%**	**46%**	23%	1.8–2.0×	Payments: 29% / 27% (5.3×)
SMS	**8%**	**5%**	1.9%	2.6–4.2×	Payroll: 19% / 17% (3.1×)
Transactional Email	1.5%	2.0%	2.1%	~1×	BillPay: 18% / 16% (8.6×)
WhatsApp	0%	0%	~0%	N/A	—

Automations is Mailchimp's standout — **46% for Claude** and **40% for ChatGPT**, nearly double the platform average and exceeding QBO's top metric (Payments at 29%). Claude leads ChatGPT by 5.5 pts. However, QBO's **multi-product multiplier is 3–8×** vs Mailchimp's **1.8–4.2×**. QBO's depth across secondary products (Payroll 19%, BillPay 18%) far exceeds Mailchimp's SMS at 5–8%. ChatGPT edges Claude on SMS (8% vs 5%), likely because its older user base has had more time to expand into paid add-ons.

New Customer Acquisition Critical Failure

Channel	New MC Signups	Paid Conversion	Best Traditional	Worst Traditional
ChatGPT	278 (130 days)	0%	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%
Claude	103 (10 days)	1.9% (2 users)	Shopify: 20.7%	BeatStars: 10.5%

All 278 ChatGPT-sourced signups remain on free plans after 130 days — **not one has converted to paid**. Claude has 2 free-trial starts out of 103. Even the weakest traditional channel converts at 7–10%. The AI connectors are **the lowest-performing acquisition channels in Mailchimp's entire portfolio**. QBO did not report this metric separately, but their strong attachment numbers suggest their AI-sourced users monetize; Mailchimp's do not.

Scorecard

Dimension	QBO vs MC	ChatGPT vs Claude (within MC)
Scale	QBO leads ~2×	ChatGPT leads (2,899 vs 2,693) but Claude will pass imminently
Growth velocity	QBO leads	Claude dominates (269/day vs 15/day)
Engagement	MC leads (+10–33 pts)	Claude leads (82% vs 63% WAU)
Top product attachment	MC leads (Automations 40–46%)	Claude leads (46% vs 40%)
Multi-product depth	QBO leads (3–8× vs 1.8–4.2×)	ChatGPT slightly (8% vs 5% SMS)
New customer conversion	QBO leads (MC at 0–1.9%)	Neither works (0% vs 1.9%)

Growth Lever: Embedding the Analytics Agent in ChatGPT & Claude Opportunity

Mailchimp's GenAI analytics features — **Marketing Analyzer** (campaign insights), **Segmentation AI** (natural-language segment creation), and **CJB Smart Draft** (automation content) — show high adoption and strong payoff among eligible users. Today, these features are only available inside the Mailchimp app for paid users. Bundling them into the ChatGPT and Claude connector experience would unlock significant incremental value.

Current State: GenAI-Eligible AI Connector Users Already Outperform

Payoff Action	ChatGPT Users		Claude Users		Platform WAU Avg
	GenAI Eligible	Not Eligible	GenAI Eligible	Not Eligible	(GenAI Eligible)
Segment creation	**70.4%**	23.5%	**66.9%**	31.3%	52.7%
Email sends	**88.8%**	38.2%	**88.5%**	54.1%	—
Avg segment actions	**91**	25	**62**	22	—
Avg emails delivered	**435K**	131K	**241K**	78K	—

GenAI-eligible AI connector users create segments at **3× the rate** of non-eligible ones (70% vs 24% for ChatGPT; 67% vs 31% for Claude) and send **3× more emails**. They also outperform the platform-wide GenAI-eligible average for segment creation (70% vs 53%), indicating that the AI connector + GenAI combination is more potent than either alone.

Payoff by Plan Tier: Premium Users Are Near-Maximum

Plan Tier	ChatGPT			Claude		
	Automations	Segments	SMS	Automations	Segments	SMS
Premium	**86%**	**90%**	**33%**	**94%**	**96%**	16%
Standard	64%	68%	14%	63%	64%	8%
Legacy	62%	74%	9%	61%	76%	7%
Free (no GenAI)	24%	24%	3%	27%	31%	2%

Premium Claude users reach **94% Automation adoption and 96% segment creation** — near saturation. Standard-tier users (the largest cohort) sit at ~64%, presenting the clearest growth opportunity. Free-tier users at 24–31% confirm the pattern: without GenAI features, payoff actions drop by half or more.

Projected Impact: If Analytics Agent Were Embedded in ChatGPT/Claude

> **The case for embedding:** Today, 1,743 ChatGPT users and 1,322 Claude users (~60% and 49% of their bases) are on free plans with **no access to Marketing Analyzer, Segmentation AI, or Smart Draft**. Their segment-creation rate is 24–31% and email-send rate is 38–54%. If the analytics agent were surfaced through the ChatGPT/Claude connector — even for free users — the data suggests these rates could **2–3× to approach the 67–70% segment creation** and **89% email send rates** seen among GenAI-eligible users.

Scenario	Population	Current Segment Creation	Projected w/ Analytics Agent	Incremental Users Creating Segments
All AI connector users	5,592	2,555 (46%)	~3,800 (68%)	**+1,245**
Paid users only	2,527	1,731 (69%)	~2,150 (85%)	**+419**
Premium / high-value	122	113 (93%)	~119 (97%)	+6 (near ceiling)
Free-tier users	3,065	824 (27%)	~1,650 (54%)	**+826**

The largest uplift is in free-tier users (826 incremental segment creators), which also has a downstream implication: users who create segments and send targeted emails are historically more likely to upgrade to paid plans. This positions the analytics agent as both a **payoff accelerator** and a potential **fix for the zero paid-conversion problem** identified earlier — by giving free users a taste of AI-powered segmentation, you create a natural upgrade trigger.

For paid users, embedding the analytics agent in the connector experience could push Standard-tier segment creation from 64–68% toward the Premium-tier ceiling of 90–96%, driving **incremental Automation and SMS adoption** as a downstream effect.

Strategic Implication

> The AI connectors deliver **strong engagement and Automations adoption among existing paid users** — a genuine competitive advantage over QBO. But they are **failing completely as acquisition channels**: zero meaningful paid conversion from new signups, which even the weakest traditional channel achieves at 7–10%.

The analytics agent is the bridge. Embedding Marketing Analyzer and Segmentation AI into the ChatGPT/Claude experience could simultaneously (1) **double payoff actions** among the 3,065 free-tier connector users, (2) **create a natural upgrade trigger** by letting free users experience AI-powered segmentation, and (3) **push Standard-tier users toward Premium-level engagement** (from ~64% to ~90% segment creation). This makes the analytics agent the single highest-leverage investment for turning these channels from engagement-only tools into revenue contributors.

Claude is the stronger channel on every forward-looking metric (velocity, engagement, Automations attachment), while ChatGPT is declining and should be monitored for intervention. The key decision: **embed the analytics agent to accelerate payoff and fix the free-to-paid funnel**, rather than accepting zero conversion as the status quo.

Data source: `mc-business-intelligence` BigQuery | Tables: `bi_reporting.integrations`, `bi_reporting.orders`, `bi_reporting.users`, `bi_reporting.users_weekly_rollup`, `bi_reporting_beta.monthly_genai_user_eligibility`, `bi_reporting.sms_daily_rollup`, `bi_reporting.emails_customer_journey`, `bi_reporting.daily_transactional_sends`, `bi_reporting.messaging_outreach_daily_rollup`

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